

Modular Forms

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Contents

1	The Upper-half Plane and Congruence Subgroups	1
1.1	The Upper-half Plane	1
1.2	Congruence Subgroups	2
1.3	Fuchsian Groups and Modular Curves	6
1.4	Double Coset Decompositions and Exponential Sums	14
2	Modular Forms	16
2.1	Modular Forms	16
2.2	The Valence Formula and Petersson Inner Product	20
3	Arithmetic of Modular Forms on Hecke Congruence Subgroups	26
3.1	Poincaré and Eisenstein Series	26

1 The Upper-half Plane and Congruence Subgroups

For any complex z let

$$e(z) = e^{2\pi iz}.$$

Also, we will distinguish the primitive third root of unity $\omega = e\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)$. All sums and products over a quotient group will be consider to be over a complete set of representatives. If an integer a is taken modulo m , for any positive integer m , we write $\bar{a}$ for the inverse of a .

1.1 The Upper-half Plane

The group $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ acts on the Riemann sphere $\widehat{\mathbb{C}}$ by Möbius transformations. Explicitly, any $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ acts on $z \in \widehat{\mathbb{C}}$ by

$$\alpha z = \frac{az + b}{cz + d}.$$

Moreover, this group action is by automorphisms of the Riemann sphere and is invariant under scalar multiplication as well as negation. A short computation shows

$$\mathrm{Im}(\alpha z) = \det(\alpha) \frac{\mathrm{Im}(z)}{|cz + d|^2}, \tag{1}$$

Therefore α preserves the sign of the imaginary part of z . This means $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ preserves the upper half-plane $\mathbb{H}$, the lower half-plane $\overline{\mathbb{H}}$, and the extended real line $\widehat{\mathbb{R}}$. Of course, the subgroup $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$ also preserves $\widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$.

We will be primarily interested in this action on the upper-half plane $\mathbb{H}$. We equip $\mathbb{H}$ with the **hyperbolic measure** $d\mu$ given by

$$d\mu = \frac{dx dy}{y^2}.$$

This is simply the Lebesgue measure on $\mathbb{C}$ restricted to $\mathbb{H}$ and scaled by a factor of $\frac{1}{y^2}$. The most important property about the hyperbolic measure is that it is $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ -invariant.

Proposition 1.1. *The hyperbolic measure is $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ -invariant.*

Proof. Let $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$. Since αz is a Möbius transformation it satisfies the Cauchy-Riemann equations. So for the change of variables $z \mapsto \alpha z$, the absolute value of the Jacobian determinant is the absolute value of the square of the derivative of αz . A short computation shows that this is $\frac{\det(\alpha)^2}{|cz+d|^4}$. From this fact and Equation (1), a short computation shows

$$\mu(\alpha z) = \mu(z).$$

This means $d\mu$ is $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ -invariant. □

1.2 Congruence Subgroups

To define congruence subgroups, we first need to introduce an associated group. We call $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ the **modular group** which is the group of matrices with integer entries and of determinant 1. We will distinguish two matrices

$$S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The first matrix is of order 4 while the second has infinite order. They act on $z \in \mathbb{H}$ by

$$Sz = -\frac{1}{z} \quad \text{and} \quad Tz = z + 1,$$

respectively. Therefore S acts by a pseudo-inversion while T acts by unit translation. The first result usually proved about the modular group is that it is generated by S and T .

Proposition 1.2.

$$\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) = \langle S, T \rangle.$$

Proof. Let n be an integer and $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. We will prove $\gamma \in \langle S, T \rangle$ by demonstrating that it can be reduced to the identity matrix. If $c = 0$ then γ is the identity matrix since $\det(\gamma) = 1$ and we are done. So suppose $c \neq 0$ and write $a = qc + r$ for some integers q and r with $|r| < |c|$. A short computation shows

$$ST^{-q}\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} -c & -d \\ r & b - qd \end{pmatrix}.$$

The upper-left entry of this matrix strictly larger than the lower-left entry in absolute value. Therefore if we repeatedly apply this argument, it must terminate with the lower-left entry vanishing. But then we have reached the identity matrix. $\square$

We can now introduce congruence subgroups which are special subgroups of the modular group defined by congruence conditions on their entries. We begin with principal congruence subgroups. For a positive integer N , the **principal congruence subgroup** $\Gamma(N)$ of level N is defined by

$$\Gamma(N) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N} \right\}.$$

This congruence subgroup consists of the matrices which reduce to the identity modulo N . Whence $\Gamma(N)$ is the kernel of the homomorphism

$$\pi : \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z}) \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N},$$

and is therefore a normal subgroup. A subgroup Γ of the modular group is said to be a **congruence subgroup** if it contains a principal congruence subgroup. The minimal such N for which $\Gamma(N) \subseteq \Gamma$ is called the **level** of Γ . Note that if $M \mid N$ then $\Gamma(N) \subseteq \Gamma(M)$. Thus if Γ is a congruence subgroup of level N then it contains the principal congruence subgroups $\Gamma(kN)$ for all positive integers k . This implies that congruence subgroups are preserved under intersection. In fact, if Γ_1 and Γ_2 are congruence subgroups of levels N_1 and N_2 then $\Gamma_1 \cap \Gamma_2$ is guaranteed to be a congruence subgroup of level at most $[N_1, N_2]$. Also, it turns out that the aforementioned homomorphism is surjective.

Proposition 1.3. *Let N be a positive integer. Then the homomorphism*

$$\pi : \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z}) \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N},$$

given by natural projection, is surjective.

Proof. Let U and L be the matrices in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})$ given by

$$U = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad L = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

A short computation shows that these are the images of T and TST under π respectively. So Proposition 1.2 will imply that π is surjective provided U and L generate $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})$. So let $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})$. We will prove $\gamma \in \langle U, L \rangle$ by demonstrating that it can be reduced to the identity matrix. To show this, observe that $U^n = U(n)$ and $L^n = L(n)$ where $U(n)$ and $L(n)$ are the upper and lower unipotent matrices

$$U(n) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & n \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad L(n) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ n & 1 \end{pmatrix},$$

for n modulo N . So it suffices to show that this collection of unipotent matrices generates $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})$. If $c = 0$ then $\det(\gamma) = 1$ implies that $d = a^{-1}$ so that $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & a^{-1} \end{pmatrix}$. Short computations show

$$U(-ab)\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & a^{-1} \end{pmatrix},$$

and

$$L(a^{-1} - 1)U(1)L(a - 1)U(-a^{-1}) = \begin{pmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & a^{-1} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Whence γ can be reduced to the identity matrix. If $c \neq 0$ then $\det(\gamma) = 1$ and therefore c is invertible. A short computation shows

$$L(-c)U((1 - a)c^{-1})\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & (d - 1)c^{-1} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix},$$

and we recognize this latter matrix is as $U((d - 1)c^{-1})$. Whence γ can again be reduced to the identity matrix. $\square$

As $\Gamma(N)$ is the kernel of this homomorphism, the result implies $[\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \Gamma(N)] = |\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}/N\mathbb{Z})|$. Since any congruence subgroup Γ contains a principal congruence subgroup of some level, it follows that Γ has finite index in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Accordingly, we set

$$d_\Gamma = [\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \Gamma].$$

We now distinguish two important classes of congruence subgroups other than the principal ones. These are the congruence subgroups

$$\Gamma_1(N) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} 1 & * \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N} \right\},$$

and

$$\Gamma_0(N) = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) : \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N} \right\},$$

both of which are of level N . These congruence subgroups consist of the matrices which reduce to unipotent upper triangular and upper triangular modulo N respectively. The latter subgroup $\Gamma_0(N)$ is called the **Hecke congruence subgroup** of level N . Note that $\Gamma(N) \subseteq \Gamma_1(N) \subseteq \Gamma_0(N)$.

Since the principal congruence subgroups are normal in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, if Γ is a congruence subgroup of level N then so is $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha$ for any $\alpha \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. In fact, something more general holds. Congruence subgroups are preserved under conjugation by elements of $\mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$ provided we restrict to those elements in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$.

Lemma 1.4. *Let Γ be a congruence subgroup and $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$. Then $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha \cap \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is a congruence subgroup. In particular, if $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha \subseteq \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ then $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha$ is a congruence subgroup.*

Proof. Let the level of Γ be N and choose a positive integer r such that $r\alpha, r\alpha^{-1} \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Z})$. Let $M = r^2N$ and notice that any $\gamma \in \Gamma(M)$ is of the form

$$\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} + M \begin{pmatrix} k_1 & k_2 \\ k_3 & k_4 \end{pmatrix},$$

for integers $k_1, \dots, k_4$. Therefore $\Gamma(M) \subseteq I + M\mathrm{Mat}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ and so

$$\alpha\Gamma(M)\alpha^{-1} \subseteq I + N\mathrm{Mat}_2(\mathbb{Z}).$$

As $\Gamma(N) = (I + N\mathrm{Mat}_2(\mathbb{Z})) \cap \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, it follows that $\alpha\Gamma(M)\alpha^{-1} \subseteq \Gamma(N)$. Whence $\Gamma(M) \subseteq \alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha$ because Γ is of level N . Intersecting with $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ proves the first statement. The second statement is immediate. $\square$

Note that in the case $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha \subseteq \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, normality of principal congruence subgroups force Γ and $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha$ to be of the same level. In particular, this will always happen whenever we conjugate by elements of the modular group.

Also, since congruence subgroups are preserved under intersection, the previous lemma further implies that $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2$ is a congruence subgroup for any two congruence subgroups Γ_1 and Γ_2 and any $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$. In this setting, consider the double coset

$$\Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2 = \{\gamma_1\alpha\gamma_2 : \gamma_1 \in \Gamma_1 \text{ and } \gamma_2 \in \Gamma_2\}.$$

Note that Γ_1 acts on $\Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2$ by left multiplication so that it decomposes into a disjoint union of orbits. That is,

$$\Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2 = \bigcup_{\beta \in \Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2} \Gamma_1\beta.$$

It turns out that this union is finite. To see this, we need to relate the orbit space $\Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2$ to a quotient of Γ_2 with respect to the action of some subgroup. Consider the congruence subgroup $\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2$ which is a subgroup of Γ_2 . As this subgroup acts on Γ_2 by left multiplication, we again have an orbit space $(\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2) \backslash \Gamma_2$. We first show how these orbit spaces are related.

Lemma 1.5. *Let Γ_1 and Γ_2 be congruence subgroups and let $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$. Then the right multiplication map*

$$\Gamma_2 \rightarrow \Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2 \quad \gamma_2 \mapsto \Gamma_1\alpha\gamma_2,$$

induces a bijection from $(\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2) \backslash \Gamma_2$ to $\Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1\alpha\Gamma_2$.

Proof. We first show that this map is $(\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2)$ -invariant so that it induces a map on the quotient. Indeed, if $\gamma \in \alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2$ then $\gamma = \alpha^{-1}\gamma_1\alpha$ for some $\gamma_1 \in \Gamma_1$. Thus $\Gamma_1\alpha\gamma\gamma_2 = \Gamma_1\alpha\gamma_2$ as claimed. We now show that the induced map is a bijection.

We will prove injectivity and then surjectivity. For the former, let γ_2 and γ'_2 be representatives of orbits of $(\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2) \backslash \Gamma_2$ such that $\Gamma_1\alpha\gamma_2 = \Gamma_1\alpha\gamma'_2$. This implies $\alpha\gamma_2(\gamma'_2)^{-1} \in \Gamma_1\alpha$ and so $\gamma_2(\gamma'_2)^{-1} \in \alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha$. But we also have $\gamma_2(\gamma'_2)^{-1} \in \Gamma_2$ and these two facts together imply that $\gamma_2(\gamma'_2)^{-1} \in \alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2$. Hence

$$(\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2)\gamma_2 = (\alpha^{-1}\Gamma_1\alpha \cap \Gamma_2)\gamma'_2,$$

from which injectivity follows. For the latter, any representative β of an orbit in $\Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1 \alpha \Gamma_2$ is of the form $\beta = \gamma_1 \alpha \gamma_2$ for some $\gamma_1 \in \Gamma_1$ and $\gamma_2 \in \Gamma_2$. But then γ_2 represents an orbit of $(\alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2) \backslash \Gamma_2$ mapping to the orbit represented by β as $\Gamma_1 \beta = \Gamma_1 \alpha \gamma_2$. This shows surjectivity. $\square$

With this lemma in hand, we can prove that the aforementioned disjoint union is finite.

Proposition 1.6. *Let Γ_1 and Γ_2 be congruence subgroups and let $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$. Then the disjoint union*

$$\Gamma_1 \alpha \Gamma_2 = \bigcup_{\beta \in \Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1 \alpha \Gamma_2} \Gamma_1 \beta,$$

is finite.

Proof. By Lemma 1.5, the number of orbits of $\Gamma_1 \backslash \Gamma_1 \alpha \Gamma_2$ is in bijection with those of $(\alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2) \backslash \Gamma_2$ which is $[\Gamma_2 : \alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2]$. By Lemma 1.4, $\alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is a congruence subgroup and thus $\alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2$ is as well. It follows that $[\Gamma_2 : \alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2] \leq d_{\alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2}$ where $d_{\alpha^{-1} \Gamma_1 \alpha \cap \Gamma_2}$ is finite which completes the proof. $\square$

1.3 Fuchsian Groups and Modular Curves

We first restrict our group action on the upper-half plane to $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$. Note that for any $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, Equation (1) simplifies to

$$\mathrm{Im}(\alpha z) = \frac{\mathrm{Im}(z)}{|cz + d|^2}. \quad (2)$$

So $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ preserves the upper half-plane $\mathbb{H}$, the lower half-plane $\overline{\mathbb{H}}$, and the extended real line $\widehat{\mathbb{R}}$. Of course, the subgroup $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Q})$ also preserves $\widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$.

A subgroup Δ of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ is said to be **Fuchsian** if it is discrete and acts properly discontinuously on $\mathbb{H}$. The modular group is the prototypical example of a Fuchsian group.

Proposition 1.7. *The modular group is Fuchsian.*

Proof. $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ is discrete in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ because $\mathbb{Z}$ is discrete in $\mathbb{R}$. So it remains to show that $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ acts properly discontinuously on $\mathbb{H}$. To prove this, it suffices to show that for any compact subset $K \subset \mathbb{H}$ there are finitely many $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ satisfying $\gamma K \cap K \neq \emptyset$. Set $M = \min_{z \in K} \mathrm{Im}(z)$. If $\gamma K \cap K \neq \emptyset$ then there exists a $z \in K$ such that $\mathrm{Im}(\gamma z) \geq M$. This inequality is equivalent to

$$(cx + d)^2 + (cy)^2 \leq \frac{y}{M},$$

by Equation (2), which is only satisfied for finitely many pairs of relatively prime integers (c, d) since $y > 0$. Each pair determines infinitely many matrices $\gamma_k = \begin{pmatrix} a+kc & b+kd \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ possibly satisfying $\gamma_k K \cap K \neq \emptyset$. As K is compact it has bounded real part and so only finitely many such k satisfy this condition. Hence there are finitely many possible matrices γ . $\square$

As an immediate consequence of this result, any subgroup or conjugate of the modular group is also Fuchsian. In particular, all congruence subgroups and their conjugates are Fuchsian.

Since any Fuchsian group Δ acts properly discontinuously on $\mathbb{H}$ and the hyperbolic measure is $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ -invariant by Proposition 1.1, the hyperbolic measure induces a measure on the quotient $\Delta \backslash \mathbb{H}$ which we also denote by $d\mu$. Moreover, there exist fundamental domains $\mathcal{F}_\Delta$ for $\Delta \backslash \mathbb{H}$ which are integrable with respect to the hyperbolic measure so that

$$\int_{\Delta \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) d\mu = \int_{\mathcal{F}_\Delta} f(z) d\mu,$$

for any Δ -invariant complex function f on $\mathbb{H}$. In particular, we define the **covolume** V_Δ of Δ to be

$$V_\Delta = \int_{\Delta \backslash \mathbb{H}} d\mu.$$

A Fuchsian group Δ is said to be of the **first kind** if its covolume is finite. In this case, the integral of any Δ -invariant function f over $\Delta \backslash \mathbb{H}$ is absolutely convergent whenever f is bounded.

It turns out that the modular group is Fuchsian of the first kind, but to show this we need to produce a fundamental domain for $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathbb{H}$ which are integrable with respect to the hyperbolic measure. In fact, we will show that a fundamental domain is

$$\mathcal{F} = \left\{ z \in \mathbb{H} : |\mathrm{Re}(z)| \leq \frac{1}{2} \text{ and } |z| \geq 1 \right\}.$$

Proposition 1.8. $\mathcal{F}$ is a fundamental domain for $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathbb{H}$.

Proof. We first show any point in $\mathbb{H}$ is $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent to a point in $\mathcal{F}$. So let $z \in \mathbb{H}$ and $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Then Equation (2) gives

$$\mathrm{Im}(\gamma z) = \frac{y}{|cz + d|^2}.$$

Since $\det(\gamma) = 1$ we cannot have $c = d = 0$. As $y > 0$, it is easily checked that $|cz + d| \geq \min(y, 1)$ and thus bounded away from zero. Whence there are finitely many pairs of relatively prime integers (c, d) such that $|cz + d|^2 \leq M$ for any $M > 0$. So choose a γ such that it minimizes $|cz + d|$ and hence maximizes $\mathrm{Im}(\gamma z)$. In particular, $\mathrm{Im}(S\gamma z) \leq \mathrm{Im}(\gamma z)$ which is to say

$$\frac{\mathrm{Im}(\gamma z)}{|\gamma z|^2} \leq \mathrm{Im}(\gamma z).$$

The inequality implies $|\gamma z| \geq 1$. Since $\mathrm{Im}(T^n \gamma z) = \mathrm{Im}(\gamma z)$ for all integers n , repeating the argument above with $T^n \gamma$ in place of γ , we see that $|T^n \gamma z| \geq 1$. But T shifts the real part by 1 so we can choose n such that $|\mathrm{Re}(T^n \gamma z)| \leq \frac{1}{2}$. Therefore $T^n \gamma$ maps z into $\mathcal{F}$. It remains to show that no two distinct interior points of $\mathcal{F}$ are $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent. So suppose to the contrary that there exist distinct $z, z' \in \mathcal{F}^\circ$ and $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ such that $z' = \gamma z$. Without loss of generality, we may assume $\mathrm{Im}(z') \geq \mathrm{Im}(z)$. Then

$$\mathrm{Im}(z') = \frac{\mathrm{Im}(z)}{|cz + d|^2},$$

by Equation (2) and so $|cz + d| \leq 1$. As $|z| > 1$ and $|\operatorname{Re}(z)| < \frac{1}{2}$, short computations show that this inequality is valid only if $c = 0$. Then $\det(\gamma) = 1$ forces $a = d = \pm 1$. Finally, $|\operatorname{Re}(z)| < \frac{1}{2}$ further forces $b = 0$. But then $\gamma = \pm I$ which gives a contradiction since we assumed z and z' were distinct. $\square$

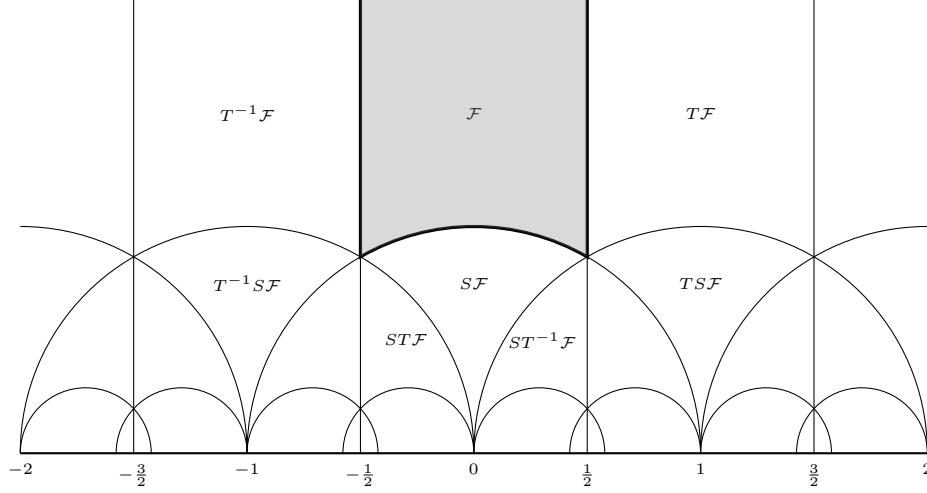


Figure 1: The standard fundamental domain for $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathbb{H}$.

The region $\mathcal{F}$, shaded in Figure 1, is called the **standard fundamental domain**. Any $z \in \mathcal{F}$ satisfies $\operatorname{Im}(z) \geq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$. Indeed, z occurs on the arc of a circle of radius $r \geq 1$ subject to $|\operatorname{Re}(z)| \leq \frac{1}{2}$. Then $\operatorname{Im}(z)$ is minimized on the arc $|z| = 1$, and on this arc

$$\operatorname{Im}(z) = \sqrt{1 - \operatorname{Re}(z)^2}.$$

The right-hand side is minimized at $\operatorname{Re}(z) = \pm \frac{1}{2}$ giving $\operatorname{Im}(z) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$. This corresponds to the points $-\frac{1}{2} + i\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ and $\frac{1}{2} + i\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ which are ω and $1 + \omega$ respectively. They are the vertices of the boundary of $\mathcal{F}$.

If Γ is a congruence subgroup, we can use the standard fundamental domain to produce a fundamental domain for $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ which can be used to evaluate the covolume of Γ . It so happens that

$$\mathcal{F}_\Gamma = \bigcup_{\beta \in \Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})} \beta \mathcal{F},$$

is a fundamental domain for $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ which is obtained from the standard fundamental domain using representatives of orbits of $\Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$.

Proposition 1.9. *$\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ is a fundamental domain for $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$.*

Proof. We first show that every point in $\mathbb{H}$ is Γ -equivalent to a point in $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$. From the definition of $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$, it is straightforward to check that

$$\bigcup_{\gamma \in \Gamma} \gamma \mathcal{F}_\Gamma = \mathbb{H}.$$

Whence every point in $\mathbb{H}$ is Γ -equivalent to a point in $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$. We will now show that no two distinct interior points of $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ are Γ -equivalent. Suppose to the contrary that there are distinct $z, z' \in \mathcal{F}_\Gamma^\circ$ and a $\gamma \in \Gamma$ such that $\gamma z = z'$. In particular, $z \in \beta \mathcal{F}^\circ$ and $z' \in \beta' \mathcal{F}^\circ$ for some $\beta, \beta' \in \Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. As no two distinct interior points of $\mathcal{F}$ are $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent, this forces β and β' to belong to the same coset of $\Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Whence $\beta = \beta'$ and implying $z, z' \in \beta \mathcal{F}^\circ \cap \beta' \mathcal{F}^\circ$. This gives a contradiction since no two distinct interior points of $\mathcal{F}$ are $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent. Hence no two distinct interior points of $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ are Γ -equivalent. $\square$

We can now show that the modular group is Fuchsian of the first kind. For brevity, we write $V = V_{\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})}$ so that

$$V = \int_{\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathbb{H}} d\mu.$$

Using Proposition 1.8 to write this integral explicitly, we obtain

$$V = \int_{-\frac{1}{2}}^{\frac{1}{2}} \int_{\sqrt{1-x^2}}^{\infty} \frac{dy dx}{y^2},$$

and a short computation shows $V = \frac{\pi}{3}$. Therefore the modular group is Fuchsian of the first kind. There is also a simple relation between V_Γ and d_Γ given by

$$V_\Gamma = d_\Gamma V, \tag{3}$$

which follows immediately from Proposition 1.9. Whence every congruence subgroup is Fuchsian of the first kind as well. Using $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ -invariance of the hyperbolic measure and the change of variables $z \mapsto \alpha^{-1}z$, a short computation shows

$$V_{\alpha^{-1}\Gamma\alpha} = V_\Gamma, \tag{4}$$

for any $\alpha \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$. So the conjugate of every congruence subgroup is also Fuchsian of the first kind.

It is also possible to say something about the stabilizer subgroups of points in $\mathbb{H}$ with respect to the action of a congruence subgroup Γ . Let Γ_z denote the stabilizer subgroup of $z \in \mathbb{H}$. Then $\Gamma_{\gamma z} = \gamma \Gamma_z \gamma^{-1}$ for any $\gamma \in \Gamma$ and it follows that all of the stabilizer subgroups are determined by those for $z \in \mathcal{F}_\Gamma$. Moreover, since $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ is a fundamental domain, Γ_z is trivial if $z \in \mathcal{F}_\Gamma^\circ$. So any point with a nontrivial stabilizer subgroups must lie on the boundary of $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$. As Γ is a subgroup of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, we conclude Γ_z is a subgroup of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z$. This leads us to determining the stabilizer subgroups in the case of the modular group.

Proposition 1.10. *Let $z \in \mathcal{F}$. Then*

$$\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z = \begin{cases} \langle S \rangle & \text{if } z = i, \\ \langle ST \rangle & \text{if } z = \omega, \\ \langle TS \rangle & \text{if } z = 1 + \omega, \\ \langle -I \rangle & \text{if } z \neq i, \omega, 1 + \omega. \end{cases}$$

Moreover, $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_i$ is of order 4 while $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega$ and $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega}$ are of order 6.

Proof. Let $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Then $\gamma z = z$ implies

$$cz^2 + (d - a)z - b = 0.$$

We will analyze this identity on a case by case basis. In particular, we will take $z = i$, $z = \omega$, $z = 1 + \omega$, and $z \neq i, \omega, 1 + \omega$ respectively.

Taking $z = i$ in this identity gives

$$-c + (d - a)i - b = 0.$$

Equating the real and imaginary parts shows that $b = -c$ and $d = a$. Then $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & -c \\ c & a \end{pmatrix}$ and $a^2 + c^2 = 1$. Therefore we have $a = 1$ and $c = 0$, $a = -1$ and $c = 0$, $a = 0$ and $c = 1$, or $a = 0$ and $c = -1$. These four cases correspond to the matrices I , $-I$, S , and $-S$ respectively. Since $S^2 = -I$, it follows that $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_i = \langle S \rangle$ and is of order 4.

Taking $z = \omega$ in the identity instead gives

$$c\omega^2 + (d - a)\omega - b = 0.$$

Recall that $m_\omega(x) = x^2 + x + 1$ is the minimal polynomial for ω over $\mathbb{Q}$. So $\omega^2 = -\omega - 1$ and substituting this identity into the one above yields

$$(d - a - c)\omega - (b + c) = 0.$$

By minimality of $m_\omega(x)$, ω and 1 are linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$ so we may equate coefficients to see that $d = a + c$ and $b = -c$. Then $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & -c \\ c & a+c \end{pmatrix}$ and $a^2 + ac + c^2 = 1$. Completing the square shows $(a + c)^2 - ac = 1$. Therefore we have $a = 1$ and $c = 0$, $a = -1$ and $c = 0$, $a = 0$ and $c = 1$, $a = 0$ and $c = -1$, $a = -1$ and $c = 1$, or $a = 1$ and $c = -1$. These six cases correspond to the matrices I , $-I$, ST , $(ST)^4$, $(ST)^2$, and $(ST)^5$ respectively. As $(ST)^3 = -I$, it follows that $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega = \langle ST \rangle$ and is of order 6. Moreover, if $z = 1 + \omega$ then $z = T\omega$. Whence $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega} = T\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega T^{-1} = \langle TS \rangle$ and is of order 6.

It remains to show that if $z \neq i, \omega, 1 + \omega$ then $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z = \langle I \rangle$. Equivalently, will show the contrapositive which is to say that if $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z \neq \langle -I \rangle$ then $z = i, \omega, 1 + \omega$. Since the stabilizer subgroup of z is trivial if $z \in \mathcal{F}^\circ$, we may additionally assume z lies on the boundary of $\mathcal{F}$. Now suppose for such z that $\gamma \neq \pm I$. We first claim $c > 0$. For if $c = 0$, $\det(\gamma) = 1$ implies $a = d = \pm 1$. This further forces $b = 0$ implying $\gamma = \pm I$ which is a contradiction. Hence $c \neq 0$ and so z satisfies the aforementioned identity which is a quadratic. A short computation shows that the discriminant is $(a + d)^2 - 4$. Since this quadratic has integer coefficients and z is complex, the discriminant must be negative. So

$$(a + d)^2 - 4 < 0,$$

which forces $a + d = 0, 1, -1$. These three cases correspond to the discriminant being -4 in the first case and -3 in the latter two cases. Whence the quadratic formula implies

$$z = \frac{a \pm i}{c}, \quad \text{or} \quad z = \frac{2a - 1 \pm \sqrt{3}i}{2c}, \quad \text{or} \quad z = \frac{2a + 1 \pm \sqrt{3}i}{2c},$$

respectively. In any case, recalling that $\mathrm{Im}(z) \geq \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ for $z \in \mathcal{F}$ implies $c = \pm 1$. This forces $a = 0$ in the first case, $a = 0, 1$ in the second, and $a = 0, -1$ in the third. Whence $z = i$ in the first case and $z = \omega, 1 + \omega$ in the second and third cases. This completes the proof. $\square$

Returning to the case of a congruence subgroup Γ , it follows from this result and our previous remarks that Γ_z is necessarily trivial if z is not $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent to i , ω , or $1 + \omega$. Moreover, if z is $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent to one of these points then Γ_z is trivial unless at least one of the matrices $\pm S$, $\pm ST$, or $\pm TS$ belongs to Γ respectively. In particular, Γ_z is always finite.

A **modular curve** is a quotient $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ of $\mathbb{H}$ by a congruence subgroup Γ . Observe that $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ is not compact as the fundamental domain $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ need not contain points of $\widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$. These points correspond to cusps which we now define. Recall that Γ acts on $\widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$. A **cusp class** of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ is a coset of $\Gamma \backslash \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$. There is only one cusp class for the modular group since it acts transitively. Indeed, $\widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$ is exactly the orbit of ∞ . For if $\frac{a}{c} \in \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$ with $(a, c) = 1$, Bézout's identity provides the existence of integers b and d such that $ad - bc = 1$ whence $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ satisfies $\gamma\infty = \frac{a}{c}$. Therefore the action is transitive and there can only be finitely many cosets of $\Gamma \backslash \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$ since Γ has finite index in the modular group. In other words, the number of cusp classes is finite and at most d_Γ . In particular, the orbit of ∞ is a cusp class of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. A **cusp** is a representative of a cusp class. We denote cusps by gothic characters $\mathfrak{a}$, $\mathfrak{b}$, etc.

Remark 1.11. The cusps are exactly the points needed to make a fundamental domain $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ compact as a subset of $\widehat{\mathbb{C}}$. To see this, suppose $\mathfrak{a}$ is a limit point of $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ that does not belong to $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$. Then $\mathfrak{a} \in \widehat{\mathbb{R}}$. As the unique limit point of $\mathcal{F}$ not belonging to $\mathcal{F}$ is ∞ and $\widehat{\mathbb{Q}} = \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})\infty$, Proposition 1.9 implies $\mathfrak{a} \in \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}$ which means $\mathfrak{a}$ is a cusp. In the case of the standard fundamental domain $\mathcal{F}$, the only cusp is ∞ .

We will now describe the stabilizer subgroups of Γ relative to a cusp $\mathfrak{a}$. This will slightly depend upon if Γ contains $-I$, so let $\varepsilon_\Gamma = 1, 0$ according to if $-I \in \Gamma$ or not. We will denote the stabilizer subgroup of the cusp $\mathfrak{a}$ by $\Gamma_\mathfrak{a}$. We begin by describing Γ_∞ . If $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \Gamma$ stabilizes ∞ then necessarily $c = 0$ and since $\det(\gamma) = 1$ we must have $a = d = \pm 1$ or $a = d = 1$ according to if $-I \in \Gamma$ or not. In either case, γ acts by translation by b . If we let h_∞ be the smallest positive integer such that $\gamma_\infty = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & h_\infty \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \in \Gamma_\infty$ then

$$\Gamma_\infty = \langle \gamma_\infty, (-I)^{\varepsilon_\Gamma} \rangle.$$

By our previous discussion, there exists a matrix $\eta_\mathfrak{a} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ such that $\eta_\mathfrak{a}\infty = \mathfrak{a}$. This matrix is determined up to multiplication on the right by an element of Γ_∞ . In any case, $\Gamma_\mathfrak{a} = \eta_\mathfrak{a}\Gamma_\infty\eta_\mathfrak{a}^{-1} \cap \Gamma$ and so

$$\Gamma_\mathfrak{a} = \langle \eta_\mathfrak{a}, (-I)^{\varepsilon_\Gamma} \rangle,$$

where $\gamma_\mathfrak{a}$ is of the form

$$\gamma_\mathfrak{a} = \eta_\mathfrak{a} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & h_\mathfrak{a} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \eta_\mathfrak{a}^{-1},$$

for some positive integer $h_\mathfrak{a}$. We call $h_\mathfrak{a}$ the **width** of the cusp $\mathfrak{a}$. Equivalently, $h_\mathfrak{a}$ is the shift of the minimal translation belonging to $\eta_\mathfrak{a}^{-1}\Gamma_\infty\eta_\mathfrak{a}$. Also observe that $h_\mathfrak{a}$ does not depend on the choice of $\eta_\mathfrak{a}$. We will set

$$\gamma_\infty^{(h_\mathfrak{a})} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & h_\mathfrak{a} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \Gamma_\infty^{(h_\mathfrak{a})} = \langle \gamma_\infty^{(h_\mathfrak{a})}, (-I)^{\varepsilon_\Gamma} \rangle,$$

so that

$$\eta_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1} \Gamma_{\mathbf{a}} \eta_{\mathbf{a}} = \Gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\mathbf{a}})}.$$

In particular, $\gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\infty})} = \gamma_{\infty}$ and $\Gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\infty})} = \Gamma_{\infty}$.

Remark 1.12. Suppose $\mathbf{a}'$ is a cusp that belongs to the same cusp class at $\mathbf{a}$. Then $\mathbf{a}' = \gamma \mathbf{a}$ for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$. It follows that $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \Gamma_{\infty}$ only depends upon the cusp class of $\mathbf{a}$ which is $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \infty$. Moreover, $\Gamma_{\mathbf{a}'} = \gamma \Gamma_{\mathbf{a}} \gamma^{-1}$ and $\Gamma_{\mathbf{a}'} = \gamma \eta_{\mathbf{a}} \Gamma_{\infty} \eta_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1} \gamma^{-1} \cap \Gamma$. Whence $\gamma_{\mathbf{a}'} = \gamma \gamma_{\mathbf{a}} \gamma^{-1}$ and therefore $h_{\mathbf{a}} = h_{\mathbf{a}'}$ because the width of a cusp does not depend upon the choice of $\eta_{\mathbf{a}}$. This means that the width of $\mathbf{a}$ only depends upon its cusp class and so the same is true for $\gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\mathbf{a}})}$ and $\Gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\mathbf{a}})}$.

If Γ is of level N then N is the smallest positive integer such that $\Gamma(N) \subseteq \Gamma$. This means $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & N \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ is the minimal translation guaranteed to belong to Γ . Since principal congruence subgroups are normal in the modular group, we have $\Gamma(N) \subseteq \Gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\mathbf{a}})}$ and so the aforementioned translation must be a power of $\gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\mathbf{a}})}$ which means $h_{\mathbf{a}} \mid N$. We say that Γ is **reduced** at $\mathbf{a}$ if $h_{\mathbf{a}} = 1$. For example, the congruence subgroups $\Gamma_0(N)$, $\Gamma_1(N)$, and $\Gamma(N)$ are all reduced at ∞ . The width of the cusps are also related to the index d_{Γ} in a simple manner.

Proposition 1.13. *For any congruence subgroup Γ and any cusp $\mathbf{a}$ of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$, there are $h_{\mathbf{a}}$ many cosets of $\Gamma \backslash \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. In particular,*

$$\sum_{\mathbf{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \hat{\mathbb{Q}}} h_{\mathbf{a}} = d_{\Gamma}.$$

Proof. Choose $\eta_{\mathbf{a}} \in \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ with $\eta_{\mathbf{a}} \infty = \mathbf{a}$. It follows from Remark 1.12 that the cusp classes of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ are in bijection with the double cosets of $\Gamma \backslash \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) / \Gamma_{\infty}$ where a cusp class $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \infty$ corresponds to the double coset $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \Gamma_{\infty}$ under this bijection. As the action of $\text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ on $\hat{\mathbb{Q}}$ is transitive, consider the surjection

$$\phi : \Gamma \backslash \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \Gamma \backslash \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) / \Gamma_{\infty} \quad \Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \mapsto \Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \Gamma_{\infty}.$$

We will compute the number of cosets in a fiber of ϕ . Suppose $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{a}'$ are Γ -equivalent cusps so that $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}}$ and $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}'}}$ belong to the fiber of $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \Gamma_{\infty} = \Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}'}} \Gamma_{\infty}$. Then $\eta_{\mathbf{a}'} = \gamma \eta_{\mathbf{a}} \gamma_{\infty}^n$ for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$ and integer n . Whence $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} = \Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}'}}$ if and only if $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} = \Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \gamma_{\infty}^n$ which is to say that $\gamma_{\infty}^n \in \eta_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1} \Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}}$. But then $\gamma_{\infty}^n \in \Gamma_{\infty}^{(h_{\mathbf{a}})}$ which happens if and only if $h_{\mathbf{a}} \mid n$. So the cosets $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}}$ and $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}'}}$ are equal if and only if $h_{\mathbf{a}} \mid n$. This means there are $h_{\mathbf{a}}$ cosets in the fiber of $\Gamma_{\eta_{\mathbf{a}}} \Gamma_{\infty}$. In other words, there are $h_{\mathbf{a}}$ many cosets of $\Gamma \backslash \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ proving the first statement. For the second, the sum of the number of cosets in the fibers of ϕ is equal to the order of $\Gamma \backslash \text{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ since ϕ is surjective. This is to say

$$\sum_{\mathbf{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \hat{\mathbb{Q}}} h_{\mathbf{a}} = d_{\Gamma},$$

proving the second statement. □

As it turns out, it will be more useful deal with the width of cusps implicitly. Set

$$B_\Gamma = \langle T, (-1)^{\varepsilon_\Gamma} \rangle.$$

We call $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$ a **scaling matrix** for $\mathfrak{a}$ if $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}\infty = \mathfrak{a}$ and $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} = T$. This forces

$$\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} = B_\Gamma.$$

The second condition is possible only because we are allowing the entries to be real. For example, a short computation shows that we can choose the scaling matrix to be

$$\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} = \eta_{\mathfrak{a}} \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{h_{\mathfrak{a}}} & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{h_{\mathfrak{a}}}} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Observe that scaling matrices are determined up to multiplication on the right by powers of T . Also, if Γ is reduced at $\mathfrak{a}$ then we may take $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} = \eta_{\mathfrak{a}}$ so that the scaling matrix can be chosen to lie in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. In this case, $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} = B_\Gamma$. For example, this occurs at ∞ for the Hecke congruence subgroups.

Lastly, let us discuss a useful property of integrals over $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. Recall that we may use the fundamental domain $\mathcal{F}_\Gamma$ to integrate over $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ by writing

$$\int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) d\mu = \int_{\mathcal{F}_\Gamma} f(z) d\mu,$$

for any Γ -invariant complex function f on $\mathbb{H}$. As $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ is also Fuchsian of the first kind, $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \mathbb{H}$ admits fundamental domains $\mathcal{F}_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}}$ that are integrable with respect to the hyperbolic measure. So

$$\int_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) d\mu = \int_{\mathcal{F}_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}}} f(z) d\mu,$$

for any $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ -invariant complex function f on $\mathbb{H}$. It turns out that these two types of integrals are related for complex functions that are averaged over $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma$. This is known as the **unfolding/folding method**.

Theorem (Unfolding/folding method). *Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be a cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. If f is a $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ -invariant complex function on $\mathbb{H}$ then*

$$\int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} f(\gamma z) d\mu = \int_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) d\mu,$$

provided either side is absolutely convergent.

Proof. If the left-hand side converges absolutely then we may interchange the sum and integral. Upon making the change of variables $z \mapsto \gamma^{-1}z$, the Γ -invariance of $d\mu$ implies that the integral takes the form

$$\sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \int_{\gamma \mathcal{F}_\Gamma} f(z) d\mu.$$

The result follows as $\mathbb{H} = \bigcup_{\gamma \in \Gamma} \gamma \mathcal{F}$. Moreover, we can argue in reverse provided the right-hand side converges absolutely. This completes the proof. $\square$

The process of transforming the left-hand side into the right-hand side is called **unfolding** while transforming the right-hand into the left-hand side is called **folding**. In the special case of $\Gamma_\infty \backslash \mathbb{H}$, the latter integral can be computed explicitly. Indeed,

$$\mathcal{F}_{\Gamma_\infty} = \{z \in \mathbb{H} : 0 \leq \operatorname{Re}(z) \leq h_\infty \text{ and } \operatorname{Im}(z) > 0\},$$

is clearly a fundamental domain for $\Gamma_\infty \backslash \mathbb{H}$ so that

$$\int_{\Gamma_\infty \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) d\mu = \int_0^\infty \int_0^{h_\infty} f(z) \frac{dx dy}{y^2},$$

for any Γ_∞ -invariant complex function f on $\mathbb{H}$.

1.4 Double Coset Decompositions and Exponential Sums

Let $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ be cusps of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ with respective scaling matrices $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ and $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ respectively. It will be essential to have a double coset decomposition for sets of the form $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$. This is known as the **Bruhat decomposition** for $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$.

Theorem (Bruhat decomposition). *Let $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ be cusps of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ with scaling matrices $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ and $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ respectively. Then we have the disjoint decomposition*

$$\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} = \Omega_\infty \cup \left(\bigcup_{\substack{c \in \mathbb{Z}_+ \\ d \pmod{c}}} \Omega_{c/d} \right),$$

where

$$\Omega_\infty = B_\Gamma \omega_\infty B_\Gamma \quad \text{and} \quad \Omega_{c/d} = B_\Gamma \omega_{c/d} B_\Gamma,$$

with $\omega_\infty = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & * \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ and $\omega_{c/d} = \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ if such matrices exists otherwise Ω_∞ and $\Omega_{c/d}$ are empty respectively. In the former case for Ω_∞ , ω_∞ exists if and only if $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are Γ -equivalent. In the former case for $\Omega_{c/d}$, a and d are determined modulo c and $\Omega_{c/d}$ does not depend on the entry a of $\omega_{c/d}$.

Proof. As $B_\Gamma = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ and $B_\Gamma = \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}^{-1} \Gamma_{\mathfrak{b}} \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$, short computations show that $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ is invariant under multiplication on the left or right by elements B_Γ . This proves Ω_∞ and $\Omega_{c/d}$ are subsets of $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$. Now any $\omega_\infty \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ satisfies $\omega_\infty = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$. As ω_∞ fixes ∞ , a short computation shows

$$\gamma \mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{a}.$$

This means $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are Γ -equivalent. Conversely, if $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are Γ -equivalent then $\gamma \mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{a}$ for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$ and we may take $\omega_\infty = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ because this matrix fixes ∞ . This proves that ω_∞ exists if and only if $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ are Γ -equivalent. In this case, we may write

$$\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} \omega_\infty \quad \text{and} \quad \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} = \omega_\infty \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}},$$

from which we see that the matrices in $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ acting by translation are exactly Ω_{∞} . Every other matrix in $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ belongs to one of the double cosets $\Omega_{c/d}$. The relation

$$T\omega_{c/d}T = \begin{pmatrix} a+c & * \\ c & d+c \end{pmatrix},$$

shows that $\Omega_{c/d}$ is generated uniquely by a matrix of the form $\omega_{c/d} = \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ where a and d are determined modulo c . To see that $\Omega_{c/d}$ does not depend on the entry a of $\omega_{c/d}$, let $\omega'_{c/d} = \begin{pmatrix} a' & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$. Write $\omega_{c/d} = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ and $\omega'_{c/d} = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\gamma'\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$ for some $\gamma, \gamma' \in \Gamma$. The relations

$$\omega_{c/d}(\omega'_{c/d})^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \gamma(\gamma')^{-1} = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}\omega_{c/d}(\omega'_{c/d})^{-1}\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1},$$

imply $\gamma(\gamma')^{-1} \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. So $\omega_{c/d}(\omega'_{c/d})^{-1} \in B_{\Gamma}$ whence $B_{\Gamma}\omega_{c/d}B_{\Gamma} = B_{\Gamma}\omega'_{c/d}B_{\Gamma}$. $\square$

As the double cosets Ω_{∞} and $\Omega_{c/d}$ in the Bruhat decomposition may very well be empty, we would like to track exactly which are not. To do this, let $\mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c)$ be the sets

$$\mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}} = \left\{ c \in \mathbb{Z}_+ : \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ c & * \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} \right\} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c) = \left\{ d \in \mathbb{Z}/c\mathbb{Z} : \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} \right\},$$

where $\mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c)$ is defined for $c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}$. These sets are constructed so that $\mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c)$ run over precisely the pairs (c, d) for which $\Omega_{c/d}$ is nonempty. Indeed, we may write

$$\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} = \Omega_{\infty} \cup \left(\bigcup_{\substack{c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}} \\ d \in \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c)}} \Omega_{c/d} \right),$$

where none of the double cosets $\Omega_{c/d}$ are empty.

We will now introduce two type of exponential sum associated to pairs of cusps. These are types of Kloosterman and Salié sums. We begin with the Kloosterman sums. For any $c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}$ and integers m and n , the **Kloosterman sum** $K_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(m, n, c)$ relative to $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ is defined by

$$K_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(m, n, c) = \sum_{\substack{d \in \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c) \\ \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}}} e\left(\frac{ma + nd}{c}\right).$$

This sum is well-defined since a and d are determined modulo c by the Bruhat decomposition. If $m = n = 0$ then

$$K_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(0, 0, c) = |\mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c)|.$$

The Salié sums are defined in a similar manner. For any $c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}$, integers m and n , and Dirichlet character χ modulo c , the **Salié sum** $S_{\chi,\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(m, n, c)$ relative to $\mathfrak{a}$ and $\mathfrak{b}$ is defined by

$$S_{\chi,\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(m, n, c) = \sum_{\substack{d \in \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a},\mathfrak{b}}(c) \\ \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}}} \chi(d) e\left(\frac{ma + nd}{c}\right).$$

Similar as before, this sum is well-defined since a and d are determined modulo c by the Bruhat decomposition and that the χ is a character modulo c . The usual Kloosterman and Salié sums can be obtained from those relative to cusps. Indeed, consider the case where $\Gamma = \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ and $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{b} = \infty$. As the entries a and d in $\omega_{c/d} = \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$ are determined modulo c , we may take $d = a^{-1}$ because $\det(\omega_{c/d}) = 1$. Also, $\mathcal{C}_{\infty, \infty} = \mathbb{Z}_+$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\infty, \infty}(c) = (\mathbb{Z}/c\mathbb{Z})^*$ because if $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ we must have $(c, d) = 1$ as $\det(\gamma) = 1$ and every such pair gives rise to a matrix in $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Whence

$$K_{\infty, \infty}(n, m, c) = K(n, m, c) \quad \text{and} \quad S_{\chi, \infty, \infty}(n, m, c) = S_{\chi}(n, m, c),$$

which are the usual Kloosterman and Salié sums respectively. In these cases, we will suppress the dependencies upon the cusps.

2 Modular Forms

For any complex z let

$$e(z) = e^{2\pi iz}.$$

Also, we will distinguish the primitive third root of unity $\omega = e(\frac{1}{3})$. All sums and products over a quotient group will be considered to be over a complete set of representatives. If an integer a is taken modulo m , for any positive integer m , we write $\bar{a}$ for the inverse of a .

2.1 Modular Forms

For all $\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$ and $z \in \mathbb{H}$, define $j(\alpha, z)$ by

$$j(\alpha, z) = (cz + d).$$

With this notation, Equation (1) becomes

$$\mathrm{Im}(\alpha z) = \det(\alpha) \frac{\mathrm{Im}(z)}{|j(\alpha, z)|^2}.$$

There is a very useful property that $j(\alpha, z)$ satisfies. To state it, let $\alpha' = \begin{pmatrix} a' & b' \\ c' & d' \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$. Then

$$\alpha\alpha' = \begin{pmatrix} a'a + b'c & a'b + b'd \\ c'a + d'c & c'b + d'd \end{pmatrix},$$

and from this identity, a short computation shows

$$j(\alpha'\alpha, z) = j(\alpha', \alpha z)j(\alpha, z).$$

This identity is called the **cocycle condition** for $j(\alpha, z)$. For any nonnegative integer k and $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{R})$, we define the **slash operator** $|_k\alpha : C(\mathbb{H}) \rightarrow C(\mathbb{H})$ to be the linear operator given by

$$(f|_k\alpha)(z) = \det(\alpha)^{\frac{k}{2}} j(\alpha, z)^{-k} f(\alpha z).$$

In the case of $\alpha \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{R})$, the slash operator takes the simplified form

$$(f|_k\alpha)(z) = j(\alpha, z)^{-k} f(\alpha z).$$

In any case, the cocycle condition implies that the slash operator is multiplicative as short computations show

$$(f|_k\alpha'\alpha)(z) = ((f|_k\alpha')|_k\alpha)(z) \quad \text{and} \quad ((fg)|_{k+\ell}\alpha)(z) = (f|_k\alpha)(z)(g|_\ell\alpha)(z),$$

for $f, g \in C(\mathbb{H})$, positive integers k and ℓ , and any $\alpha, \alpha' \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$. For fixed k , an operator on $C(\mathbb{H})$ is said to be **invariant** if it commutes with the slash operators $|_k\alpha$ for every $\alpha \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Q})$.

We can now introduce modular forms. Let Γ be a congruence subgroup of level N and $\nu : \Gamma \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^*$ be a finite order homomorphism. We say that a function $f : \mathbb{H} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is **modular form** on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ of **weight** k , **level** N , and **nebentypus** ν if the following properties are satisfied:

- (i) f is holomorphic on $\mathbb{H}$.
- (ii) $(f|_k\gamma)(z) = \nu(\gamma)f(z)$ for all $\gamma \in \Gamma$.
- (iii) $(f|_k\gamma)(z) = O(1)$ for all $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$.

Furthermore, we say f is a **cusp form** if the additional property is satisfied:

- (iv) For all cusps $\mathfrak{a}$ and positive y , we have

$$\int_0^1 (f|_k\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) dx = 0.$$

Property (ii) is called the **modularity condition** and we say f is **modular**. The modularity condition can equivalently be expressed as

$$f(\gamma z) = \nu(\gamma)j(\gamma, z)^k f(z).$$

We write n_ν for the order of the nebentypus so that ν takes its values in the n_ν -th roots of unity. Moreover, we say that ν is **regular** at a cusp $\mathfrak{a}$ if $\nu(\gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}) = 1$. Equivalently, $\nu(\gamma) = 1$ for every $\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. Property (iii) is called the **growth condition** and we say f is **holomorphic at the cusps**. By modularity, it suffices to verify the growth condition for a set of scaling matrices associated to a complete set of Γ -inequivalent cusps. Therefore we only have to check this condition for finitely many matrices since the number of cusp classes is finite. Also, the growth condition is equivalent to $(f|_k\alpha)(z) = O(1)$ for all $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$. To see this, we require a lemma.

Lemma 2.1. *Every $\alpha \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$ can be written as $\alpha = \gamma\eta$ for some $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ and $\eta \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$ with $\eta = \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix}$.*

Proof. Let r be a positive integer such that $r\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Z})$. As $r\alpha$ has nonzero determinant, we cannot have $a = c = 0$. Whence we may set $a' = \frac{a}{(a,c)}$ and $c' = \frac{c}{(a,c)}$ so that a' and c' are relatively prime integers. Then there exists $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ with $\gamma^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ -c' & a' \end{pmatrix}$. Moreover, a short computation shows

$$\gamma^{-1}r\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix}.$$

The claim is complete upon setting $\eta = \gamma^{-1}\alpha$. $\square$

For the equivalence, use this lemma to write $\alpha = \gamma\eta$ for some $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ and $\eta \in \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$ with $\eta = \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix}$. The cocycle condition gives

$$(f|_k\alpha)(z) = \det(\eta)^{\frac{k}{2}} j(\eta, z) (f|_k\gamma)(\eta z),$$

and as $j(\eta, z)$ is a constant, we have $(f|_k\alpha)(z) = O(1)$ proving the forward implication. The reverse implication is clear since $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \subset \mathrm{GL}_2^+(\mathbb{Q})$.

Remark 2.2. If f is a weight k modular form with nebentypus ν on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ and $-I \in \Gamma$ then modularity implies

$$f(z) = \nu(-I)(-1)^k f(z).$$

Therefore $\nu(-I) = (-1)^k$. This means ν cannot be the identity if k is odd. In particular, there are no nonzero modular forms of odd weight with trivial nebentypus on $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$.

Modular forms also admit Fourier series. First observe that modularity implies

$$(f|_k\sigma_a)(z+1) = \nu(\gamma_a)(f|_k\sigma_a)(z),$$

which is to say $f|_k\sigma_a$ is 1-periodic up to the constant factor $\nu(\gamma_a)$. This means we only need to verify the growth condition as $y \rightarrow \infty$. In any case, as $f|_k\sigma_a$ is also smooth, it admits an absolutely and uniformly convergent Fourier series. So we may write

$$(f|_k\sigma_a)(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_a(y, n) e(nx),$$

where the sum is only over nonnegative n because holomorphy at the cusps forces $f|_k\sigma_a$ to be bounded. We can also simplify the Fourier coefficients $a_a(y, n)$. Indeed, as $f|_k\sigma_a$ is holomorphic it satisfies the Cauchy-Riemann equations so that

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial f|_k\sigma_a}{\partial x} + i \frac{\partial f|_k\sigma_a}{\partial y} \right) = 0.$$

Substituting in the Fourier series and equating coefficients we obtain the ODE

$$2\pi n a_a(y, n) + a'_a(y, n) = 0.$$

Solving this ODE by separation of variables, there exist coefficients $a_a(n)$ such that

$$a_a(y, n) = a_a(n) e(n(iy)).$$

The coefficients $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n)$ are the only part of the Fourier series depending on the cusp $\mathfrak{a}$ and scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. Using these coefficients instead, f admits a **Fourier series** at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp given by

$$(f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) e(nz),$$

with **Fourier coefficients** $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n)$. In the case $\mathfrak{a} = \infty$ and $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} = I$, we will drop these dependences by writing $f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} = f$ and $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) = a(n)$. The Fourier coefficients do not depend upon the choice of scaling matrix used for $f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ because

$$(f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} T)(z) = (f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z + 1). \quad (5)$$

Also, from property (iv) we find that f is a cusp form if and only if $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(0) = 0$ for every cusp $\mathfrak{a}$. Moreover, the Fourier coefficients corresponding to Γ -equivalent cusps have a simple relationship. Suppose $\mathfrak{b}$ and $\mathfrak{a}$ are Γ -equivalent cusps so that $\gamma \mathfrak{b} = \mathfrak{a}$ for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$. Then for associated scaling matrices $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ and $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$, we have $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} = \gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. Whence modularity gives

$$(f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \nu(\gamma) (f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z),$$

so that the n -th Fourier coefficient is multiplied by the root of unity $\nu(\gamma)$. In particular, the condition $a_{\mathfrak{a}} = 0$ only depends on the cusp class of $\mathfrak{a}$. So we only need to verify property (iv) on a complete set of Γ -inequivalent cusps. Of course, if $\nu(\gamma) = 1$ the Fourier coefficients are equal. For example, this occurs when the nebentypus is trivial.

We can also derive a bound for the Fourier coefficients of f at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp provided f is a cusp form. This bound is quite straightforward to deduce and turns out to almost be optimal. To this end, consider the integral

$$\int_0^1 (f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) \operatorname{Im}(z)^{\frac{k}{2}} e(-nz) dx.$$

On the one hand, substitute the Fourier series and use absolute convergence to interchange the sum and the integral. In view of the identity

$$\int_0^1 e((n-m)x) dx = \delta_{n-m,0}, \quad (6)$$

for positive integers n and m , every term integrates to zero except the n -th term which is $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) \operatorname{Im}(z)^{\frac{k}{2}}$. On the other hand, holomorphy at ∞ implies that the integral is $O(e^{-2\pi n \operatorname{Im}(z)})$. Whence

$$a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) \operatorname{Im}(z)^{\frac{k}{2}} \ll e^{-2\pi n \operatorname{Im}(z)}.$$

Upon setting $\operatorname{Im}(z) = \frac{1}{n}$, the right-hand side is uniformly bounded and we obtain

$$a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) \ll n^{\frac{k}{2}}.$$

This estimate is known as the **Hecke bound** for modular forms. It follows from the Hecke bound that

$$(f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) = O(e^{-2\pi y}),$$

upon summing the resulting geometric series. This implies $f|_k\sigma_a$ exhibits exponential decay and we say that f exhibits **exponential decay at the cusps**. This is stronger than simply knowing $f|_k\sigma_a$ is bounded on $\mathbb{H}$ and tends to zero as $y \rightarrow \infty$ which is provided by the fact that f is a cusp form.

In practice, we will take $\Gamma = \Gamma_0(N)$ and study modular forms on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. There are a few important simplifications when Γ is a Hecke congruence subgroup. The first, which we have already noted, is that Γ is reduced ∞ . Therefore $\Gamma_\infty = B_\Gamma$ and we may take $\sigma_\infty = I$. The second is that the nebentypus can be induced by a Dirichlet character χ modulo N . Let q be the conductor of χ so that $q \mid N$. For any $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \Gamma$ we know that $c \equiv 0 \pmod{N}$ whence a is the inverse of d modulo N and thus $(d, q) = 1$. We can define a function $\nu_\chi : \Gamma \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^*$ by

$$\nu_\chi(\gamma) = \chi(d).$$

If $\gamma' = \begin{pmatrix} a' & b' \\ c' & d' \end{pmatrix} \in \Gamma$, then the relations

$$\gamma\gamma' \equiv \begin{pmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & d'd \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N} \quad \text{and} \quad \gamma^{-1} = \begin{pmatrix} d & * \\ 0 & a \end{pmatrix} \pmod{N},$$

show

$$\nu_\chi(\gamma\gamma') = \nu_\chi(\gamma)\nu_\chi(\gamma') \quad \text{and} \quad \nu_\chi(\gamma^{-1}) = \nu_\chi(\gamma)^{-1}.$$

respectively. In other words, ν_χ is a homomorphism and it is necessarily of finite order because χ is. Therefore ν_χ satisfies the assumptions of a nebentypus. It is also regular at ∞ . In the case f has nebentypus ν_χ , we simply say that f has **character** χ and write

$$\chi(\gamma) = \nu_\chi(\gamma).$$

2.2 The Valence Formula and Petersson Inner Product

Fix a positive integer N and let Γ denote any of the congruence subgroups $\Gamma_0(N)$, $\Gamma_1(N)$, or $\Gamma(N)$. Let $\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ denote the complex vector space of all weight k modular forms with nebentypus ν on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ and write $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ for the subspace of cusp forms. In either case, if ν is trivial we will suppress this dependence. Note that if Γ_1 and Γ_2 are two congruence subgroups such that $\Gamma_1 \subseteq \Gamma_2$ then we have the inclusions

$$\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma_2, \nu) \subseteq \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma_1, \nu) \quad \text{and} \quad \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma_2, \nu) \subseteq \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma_1, \nu).$$

The vector space $\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$, and hence $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ as well, turns out to be finite dimensional. This will be accomplished by showing that any $f \in \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is determined by finitely many of its Fourier coefficients. In fact, this will follow from an exact formula relating the weight k , the index d_Γ , and the zeros of f . This is known as the valence formula and we require some notation to state it. For any $z \in \mathbb{H}$, let $v_z(f)$ be the index of the first nonzero term in the Taylor series of f at z . Equivalently, $v_z(f)$ is the order of vanishing of f at z . Note that $v_z(f)$ is necessarily nonnegative as f is holomorphic and

$$v_{\gamma z}(f) = v_z(f),$$

for any $\gamma \in \Gamma$ by modularity. For a cusp $\mathfrak{a}$ of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$, we let $v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f)$ be the index of the first nonzero term in the Fourier series of f at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp. That is, $v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f)$ is the order of vanishing of $f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$ at ∞ . To show $v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f)$ is well-defined, we need to verify that it is independent of the choice of scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. This follows from Equation (5) since scaling matrices are determined up to composition on the right by an element of Γ_{∞} . Also, $v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f)$ is again nonnegative by the holomorphy of f and

$$v_{\mathfrak{a}'}(f) = v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f),$$

for any cusp $\mathfrak{a}'$ in the same cusp class as $\mathfrak{a}$ by modularity.

Our method for proving the valence formula will be to prove it for the modular group via an application of the argument principle and then extend it to the congruence subgroup Γ . In order to do this, we will need to show how to construct a modular form on $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathbb{H}$ given one on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. The following lemma provides the answer:

Lemma 2.3. *Let $f \in \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ and set*

$$F(z) = \prod_{\beta \in \Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})} ((f|_k \beta)(z))^{n_{\nu}}.$$

Then $F \in \mathcal{M}_{kn_{\nu}d_{\Gamma}}(\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}))$.

Proof. If f is zero then so is F and the claim is obvious. So assume f is nonzero. First we must show that F is well-defined which is to say that it is independent of the representatives β . Indeed, if β and β' belong to the same orbit then $\beta'\beta^{-1} \in \Gamma$. Modularity and that ν is of order n_{ν} together show

$$((f|_k \beta')(z))^{n_{\nu}} = ((f|_k \beta)(z))^{n_{\nu}},$$

which proves F is well-defined. Since the product is finite, holomorphy of F is clear. To prove modularity, let $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$. Because β runs over a complete set of representatives for $\Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ so does $\beta\gamma$. Modularity then follows from a short computation. The growth condition, follows from that of f and the definition of F . This proves $F \in \mathcal{M}_{kn_{\nu}d_{\Gamma}}(\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}))$. $\square$

We can now state and prove the **valence formula**.

Theorem (Valence formula). *Suppose $f \in \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is nonzero. Then*

$$\sum_{\mathfrak{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}} v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f) + \sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathcal{F}_{\Gamma}} \frac{2v_z(f)}{|\Gamma_z|} = \frac{kd_{\Gamma}}{12}.$$

Proof. We will first prove the valence formula for the modular group and then extend the result to Γ . Let $F \in \mathcal{M}_k(\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}))$ be nonzero so that its zeros are isolated. We claim that all of the zeros of F satisfy $\mathrm{Im}(z) < T$ for some positive T . To see this, let the Fourier series of F be given by

$$F(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a(n)e(nz).$$

Note that F is bounded as $z \rightarrow \infty$ since it is holomorphic at ∞ . Therefore, under the change of variables $e(z) \mapsto q$ this means

$$G(q) = \sum_{n \geq 0} a(n)q^n,$$

converges absolutely provided $|q| < 1$ and where $G(0) = \lim_{z \rightarrow \infty} F(z)$. Then G is holomorphic on the interior of the unit disk and the order of vanishing of G at 0 is exactly $v_\infty(F)$. Therefore we may write

$$G(q) = q^{v_\infty(F)} H(q),$$

where H is holomorphic on the interior of the unit disk and $H(0) \neq 0$. Whence there exists a positive r such that $G(q)$ is nonzero for $0 < |q| < r$. But then $F(z)$ is nonzero for $e^{-2\pi ny} < r$ which is to say $y > -\frac{\log(r)}{2\pi y}$. Taking $T > -\frac{\log(r)}{2\pi y}$ proves the claim.

It follows that every zero ρ of F has ordinate less than T . Moreover, $\gamma\rho$ is a zero for every $\gamma \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ by modularity. For our choice of T , let $\eta = \sum_i \eta_i$ be the contour in Figure 2 where the horizontal line is along $t = T$ and the remaining contour is along the boundary of $\mathcal{F}$ except for indentations of radius ε around possible zeros of F along this boundary as well as the points i , ω , and $1 + \omega$. Moreover, the paths are chosen to be symmetric with respect to the actions of S and T so that each zero ρ belonging to $\mathcal{F}$ has exactly one representative of its orbit occurring inside η except for when $\rho = i, \omega, 1 + \omega$ which are excluded. As $v_z(F) = 0$ for every $z \in \mathcal{F} - \{i, \omega, 1 + \omega\}$ that is not a zero of F , the argument principle gives

$$\frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_\eta \frac{F'}{F}(z) dz = \sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \setminus \mathcal{F}}^* \frac{2v_z(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z|},$$

where the $*$ indicates that we are excluding the orbits of i and ω . Now define integrals

$$I_i(\varepsilon) = \int_{\eta_i} \frac{F'}{F}(z) dz,$$

so that

$$\frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_\eta \frac{F'}{F}(z) dz = \sum_i I_i(\varepsilon).$$

We will compute the integrals $I_i(\varepsilon)$ and then take the limit as $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$. For the integrals along η_2 and η_8 , modularity implies $F(z + 1) = F(z)$ and observe that $T^{-1}\eta_8 = -\eta_2$. Whence

$$I_2(\varepsilon) + I_8(\varepsilon) = 0,$$

so that these integrals cancel. For the integral along η_1 , the change of variables $e(z) \mapsto q$ takes η_1 to the circle $|q| = e^{-2\pi T}$ transversed once with negative orientation and $F(z)$ is taken to $G(q)$. Then from our previous discussion of $G(q)$, we have

$$I_1(\varepsilon) = -v_\infty(F).$$

The integrals along η_3 and η_7 , as well as η_5 , are computed in a similar manner. Let θ_ε be the angle such that η_3 and η_7 end and begin at angles $\frac{\pi}{6} + \theta_\varepsilon$ and $\frac{5\pi}{6} - \theta_\varepsilon$ relative to ω and $1 + \omega$

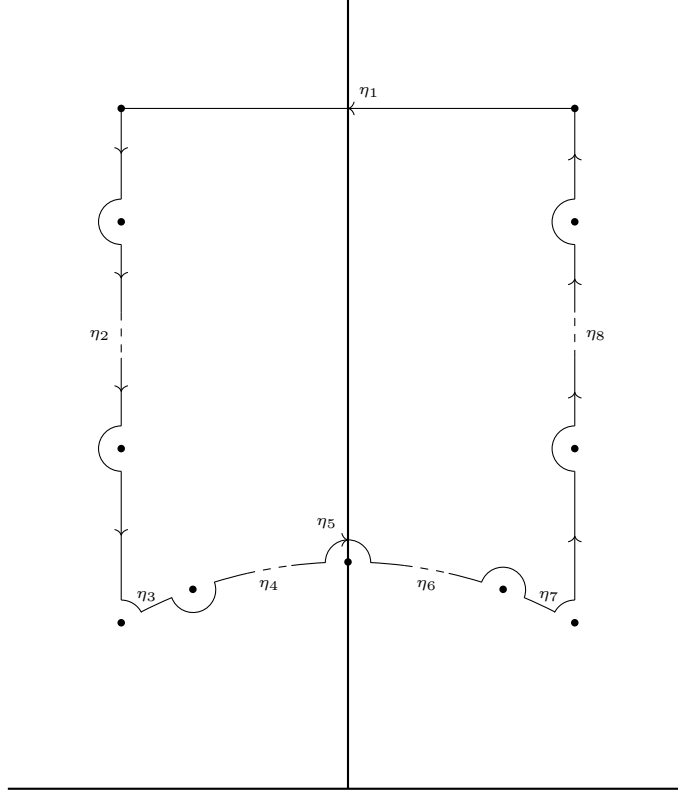


Figure 2: An indented standard fundamental domain contour.

respectively. For η_3 , write $F(z) = (z - \omega)^{v_\omega(F)} F_\omega(z)$ where $F_\omega(z)$ holomorphic and nonzero at ω . Then

$$I_3(\varepsilon) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\eta_4} \left(\frac{v_\omega(F)}{z - \omega} + \frac{F'_\omega(z)}{F_\omega(z)} \right) dz,$$

and the change of variables $z \mapsto \omega + \varepsilon e^{i\theta}$ shows

$$I_3(\varepsilon) = -\frac{\frac{\pi}{3} - \theta_\varepsilon}{2\pi} v_\omega(F) + O(\varepsilon).$$

Since $\theta_\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$ as $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$, it follows that

$$\lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} I_3(\varepsilon) = -\frac{v_\omega(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega|},$$

as $|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega| = 6$ by Proposition 1.10. We argue similarly for η_7 . Write $F(z) = (z - (1 + \omega))^{v_{1+\omega}(F)} F_{1+\omega}(z)$ where $F_{1+\omega}(z)$ holomorphic and nonzero at $1 + \omega$. Then

$$I_7(\varepsilon) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\eta_7} \left(\frac{v_{1+\omega}(F)}{z - (1 + \omega)} + \frac{F'_{1+\omega}(z)}{F_{1+\omega}(z)} \right) dz,$$

and the change of variables $z \mapsto (1 + \omega) + \varepsilon e^{i\theta}$ shows

$$I_7(\varepsilon) = \frac{\frac{\pi}{3} - \theta_\varepsilon}{2\pi} v_{1+\omega}(F) + O(\varepsilon).$$

Whence

$$\lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} I_7(\varepsilon) = -\frac{v_{1+\omega}(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega}|},$$

where $|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega}| = 6$ by Proposition 1.10. For the integral along η_5 , write $F(z) = (z - i)^{v_i(F)} F_i(z)$ where $F_i(z)$ is holomorphic and nonzero at i . Then

$$I_5(\varepsilon) = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\eta_5} \left(\frac{v_i(F)}{z - (i)} + \frac{F'_i(z)}{F_i(z)} \right) dz,$$

and the change of variables $z \mapsto i + \varepsilon e^{i\theta}$ gives

$$I_5(\varepsilon) = -\frac{v_i(F)}{2} + O(\varepsilon).$$

Therefore

$$\lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} I_5(\varepsilon) = -\frac{2v_i(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_i|},$$

as $|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_i| = 4$ by Proposition 1.10. For the integrals along η_4 and η_6 , let C_ε be the finite union of segments along η_4 that lie on the boundary of $\mathcal{F}$. Modularity implies $F(-\frac{1}{z}) = z^k F(z)$ and notice that $S^{-1}\eta_6 = -\eta_4$. Hence

$$I_4(\varepsilon) + I_6(\varepsilon) = -\frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{C_\varepsilon} \frac{k}{z} dz.$$

As $\varepsilon \rightarrow 0$, C_ε tends to the arc on the unit circle between radii $\frac{\pi}{2}$ and $\frac{2\pi}{3}$ with negative orientation. From the change of variables $z \mapsto e^{i\theta}$, we find that

$$\lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} (I_4(\varepsilon) + I_6(\varepsilon)) = \frac{k}{12}.$$

Altogether, this means

$$\lim_{\varepsilon \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\eta} \frac{F'}{F}(z) dz = \frac{k}{12} - v_\infty(F) - \frac{v_\omega(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega|} - \frac{v_{1+\omega}(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega}|} - \frac{2v_i(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_i|}, \quad (7)$$

whence

$$v_\infty(F) + \frac{v_\omega(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega|} + \frac{v_{1+\omega}(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega}|} + \frac{2v_i(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_i|} + \sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \setminus \mathcal{F}}^* \frac{2v_z(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z|} = \frac{k}{12}.$$

Since ω and $1 + \omega$ are $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ -equivalent, $v_\omega(F) = v_{1+\omega}(F)$ and $|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_\omega| = |\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_{1+\omega}|$ by Proposition 1.10. So the previous identity becomes

$$v_\infty(F) + \sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \setminus \mathcal{F}} \frac{2v_z(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z|} = \frac{k}{12},$$

which is precisely the claim for the modular group. It remains to prove the claim for Γ . So let $f \in \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ be nonzero. By Lemma 2.3 we may take

$$F(z) = \prod_{\beta \in \Gamma \setminus \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})} ((f|_k \beta)(z))^{n_\nu},$$

and obtain

$$v_\infty(F) + \sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathcal{F}} \frac{2v_z(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z|} = \frac{kmd_\Gamma}{12}.$$

Observe that the Fourier series of F is a product of the Fourier series for f over a complete set of Γ -inequivalent cusps each with multiplicity m . Therefore the index of the first nonzero term in the Fourier series of F is

$$v_\infty(F) = \sum_{\mathfrak{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \hat{\mathbb{Q}}} mv_{\mathfrak{a}}(f).$$

Lastly, modularity implies $F(z) = 0$ if and only if $f(\beta z) = 0$ for some β in which case the zero is of multiplicity m . From this and the orbit-stabilizer theorem, we find that

$$\frac{2v_z(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z|} = \sum_{\beta \in \Gamma \backslash \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})} \frac{2mv_{\beta z}(f)}{|\Gamma_{\beta z}|}.$$

But then Proposition 1.9 further implies

$$\sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathcal{F}} \frac{2v_z(F)}{|\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})_z|} = \sum_{z \in \Gamma \backslash \mathcal{F}_\Gamma} \frac{2mv_z(f)}{|\Gamma_z|}.$$

Substituting these identities into the formula for the modular group gives

$$\sum_{\mathfrak{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \hat{\mathbb{Q}}} v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f) + \sum_{z \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}) \backslash \mathcal{F}_\Gamma} \frac{2v_z(f)}{|\Gamma_z|} = \frac{kd_\Gamma}{12},$$

as desired. $\square$

With the valence formula in hand, it is not hard to show that $\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is finite dimensional.

Theorem 2.4. $\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is finite dimensional. In particular, so is $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$.

Proof. Let $f \in \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$. Recall that $v_{\mathfrak{a}}(f)$ and $v_z(f)$ are nonnegative. In particular, $v_\infty(f)$ is nonnegative and the valence formula implies $v_\infty(f) \leq \frac{kd_\Gamma}{12}$ whenever f is nonzero. Let n be a positive integer such that $n \geq \frac{kd_\Gamma}{12} + 1$ and consider the linear map $F : \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^n$ sending f to its first n Fourier coefficients. Then F is injective since $v_\infty(f) < n$ and hence $\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is finite dimensional. The second statement follows immediately. $\square$

For further developments, we will require the Petersson inner product. For $f, g \in \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ we define their **Petersson inner product** $\langle f, g \rangle_\Gamma$ by

$$\langle f, g \rangle_\Gamma = \frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) \overline{g(z)} \mathrm{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

If the congruence subgroup Γ is clear from context we will suppress the dependence. The integral is well-defined because the integrand is Γ -invariant. Moreover, as f and g have

exponential decay at the cusps, the integral is also locally absolutely uniformly convergent. We also extend the Petersson inner product to any complex functions f and g on $\mathbb{H}$ provided the integrand is Γ -invariant and the integral is locally absolutely uniformly convergent.

The Petersson inner product makes $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ into a complex Hilbert space. Indeed, it is clearly linear on $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$. It is also positive definite since

$$\langle f, f \rangle = \frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} |f(z)|^2 \text{Im}(z)^k d\mu,$$

which is nonnegative and zero if and only if f is identically zero. A short computation together using the fact that $\overline{d\mu} = d\mu$, which holds since $d\mu = \frac{dx dy}{y^2}$, proves conjugate symmetry. Whence $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is a complex inner product space with respect to the Petersson inner product. Since $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is finite dimensional by Theorem 2.4, it follows that $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \nu)$ is a complex Hilbert space.

3 Arithmetic of Modular Forms on Hecke Congruence Subgroups

Fix a positive integer N and set $\Gamma = \Gamma_0(N)$. For any complex z let

$$e(z) = e^{2\pi iz}.$$

All sums and products over a quotient group will be considered to be over a complete set of representatives. If an integer a is taken modulo m , for any positive integer m , we write $\bar{a}$ for the inverse of a .

3.1 Poincaré and Eisenstein Series

We will now introduce specific modular forms over $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. These will be constructed by averaging the slash operator over $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma$ for a cusp $\mathfrak{a}$ of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. These are the Poincaré series and Eisenstein series where the latter is a special case of the former. As Γ is a Hecke congruence subgroup, $\Gamma_\infty = B_\Gamma$ and we may take $\sigma_\infty = I$.

Fix an integer $k \geq 3$. Let m be a nonnegative integer, χ be a Dirichlet character modulo N , and $\mathfrak{a}$ be a cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ with scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. Also assume χ is regular at $\mathfrak{a}$. We define the m -th (modular) **Poincaré series** $P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z)$ of weight k with character χ on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp by

$$P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z) = \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \bar{\chi}(\gamma) \left(e(m \cdot) \Big|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \right) (z).$$

We call m the **index** of $P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z)$. If χ is trivial or $\mathfrak{a} = \infty$, we will drop these dependencies accordingly. Recall that χ is regular at ∞ .

Remark 3.1. The reason why we restrict to $k \geq 3$ is because for $k = 0, 1, 2$ the Poincaré series need not converge for any $z \in \mathbb{H}$.

The Poincaré series $P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}(z)$ is well-defined as it is independent of the choice of representatives γ and $\sigma_{\mathbf{a}}$. For the character, this is easily checked by direct computation using the fact that χ is regular at $\mathbf{a}$. For the exponential factor, the set of representatives for $\sigma_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1}\gamma$ is $\Gamma_{\infty}\sigma_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1}\gamma$ in view of $\Gamma_{\mathbf{a}} = \sigma_{\mathbf{a}}\Gamma_{\infty}\sigma_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1}$. So it suffices to show

$$\left(e(m \cdot) \Big|_k T \right) (z) = e(mz),$$

which is obvious. Whence $P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}(z)$ is well-defined. To see that $P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}(z)$ is holomorphic on $\mathbb{H}$, the Bruhat decomposition for $\sigma_{\mathbf{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\infty}$ and bounding term by term gives

$$P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}(z) \ll \sum_{(c,d) \in \mathbb{Z}_{0+}^2 - \{\mathbf{0}\}} \frac{1}{|cz + d|^k}.$$

This latter series is locally absolutely uniformly convergent for $z \in \mathbb{H}$ as $k \geq 3$. Hence $P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}(z)$ is holomorphic on $\mathbb{H}$. As for modularity, let $\eta \in \Gamma$. A short computation using the change of variables $\eta \mapsto \eta\gamma^{-1}$ shows

$$(P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}|_k \eta)(z) = \chi(\eta)P_{m,\chi,\mathbf{a}}(z).$$

To verify the growth condition, we will need a technical lemma.

Lemma 3.2. *Let $a, b > 0$ and consider set*

$$S_{a,b} = \{z \in \mathbb{H} : |\operatorname{Re}(z)| \leq a \text{ and } \operatorname{Im}(z) \geq b\}.$$

Then there exists a $\delta \in (0, 1)$ such that

$$|nz + m| \geq \delta |ni + m|,$$

for all pairs of integers (n, m) and all $z \in S_{a,b}$.

Proof. If $n = 0$ then the claim is obvious as any δ is sufficient. If $n \neq 0$ then it is equivalent to prove

$$\left| \frac{z + \frac{m}{n}}{i + \frac{m}{n}} \right| \geq \delta.$$

To this end, consider the function

$$f(z, r) = \left| \frac{z + r}{i + r} \right|,$$

for $z \in S_{a,b}$ and real r . We will prove the stronger statement $f(z, r) \geq \delta$. Clearly $f(z, r)$ is continuous on $S_{a,b} \times \mathbb{R}$ and it is also positive there since $z - r \neq 0$. A short computation shows

$$f(z, r)^2 \geq \frac{|z|^2 + r^2}{1 + r^2}.$$

Since $\frac{r^2}{1+r^2} \rightarrow 1$ as $r \rightarrow \pm\infty$, choose $Y > b$ such that $\frac{r^2}{1+r^2} \geq \frac{1}{4}$ for $|r| > Y$. Now let

$$S_{a,b}^Y = \{z \in \mathbb{H} : |\operatorname{Re}(z)| \leq a \text{ and } b \leq \operatorname{Im}(z) \leq Y\},$$

so that

$$f(z, r) \geq \frac{1}{2},$$

outside of $S_{a,b}^Y \times [-Y, Y]$. But this latter region is compact and so $f(z, r)$ attains a minimum $\delta' > 0$ on it. Setting $\delta = \min(\frac{1}{2}, \delta')$ completes the proof. $\square$

We can now verify the growth condition for $P_{m,\chi,a}(z)$. Choose a cusp $\mathfrak{b}$ and an associated scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$. Using the cocycle condition, Bruhat decomposition for $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}\Gamma\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$, and bounding term by term shows give

$$(P_{m,\chi,a}|_k\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) \ll \sum_{(c,d) \in \mathbb{Z}_{0+}^2 - \{\mathbf{0}\}} \frac{1}{|cz + d|^k}.$$

Now decompose this last sum as

$$\sum_{(c,d) \in \mathbb{Z}_{0+}^2 - \{\mathbf{0}\}} \frac{1}{|cz + d|^k} = \sum_{d \geq 1} \frac{1}{d^k} + \sum_{c \geq 1} \sum_{d \geq 0} \frac{1}{|cz + d|^k}.$$

Since the first sum on the right-hand side is bounded, it suffices to show that the double sum is too as $z \rightarrow \infty$. So let $\text{Im}(z) \geq 1$ and δ be as in Lemma 3.2. Then for any positive integer N , we may write

$$\sum_{c \geq 1} \sum_{d \geq 0} \frac{1}{|cz + d|^k} \leq \sum_{c+d \leq N} \frac{1}{|cz + d|^k} + \frac{1}{\delta^k} \sum_{c+d > N} \frac{1}{|ci + d|^k}.$$

As $k \geq 3$, the second sum on the right-hand side is the tail of an absolute convergent series. Whence it tends to zero as $N \rightarrow \infty$. As for the first sum, it is finite and each term is bounded. Together this shows that the double sum is bounded as $z \rightarrow \infty$ verifying the growth condition. We collect this work in the following theorem:

Theorem 3.3. *The Poincaré series*

$$P_{m,\chi,a}(z) = \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \bar{\chi}(\gamma) \left(e(m \cdot) \Big|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \right) (z),$$

is a weight k modular form with character χ on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$.

In the case of index zero Poincaré series, we write $E_{\chi,a}(z) = P_{0,\chi,a}(z)$ and call $E_{\chi,a}(z)$ the (modular) **Eisenstein series** of weight k and character χ on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp. It is defined by

$$E_{\chi,a}(z) = \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \bar{\chi}(\gamma) \left(1 \Big|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \right) (z).$$

Just as for the Poincaré series, if χ is trivial or $\mathfrak{a} = \infty$, we will drop these dependencies accordingly. In fact, we obtain the following theorem as a special case of the former one:

Theorem 3.4. *The Eisenstein series*

$$E_{\chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z) = \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \bar{\chi}(\gamma) \left(1 \Big|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \right) (z),$$

is a weight k modular form with character χ on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$.

We can also explicitly compute the Fourier series of the Poincaré series and Eisenstein series whose Fourier coefficients involve Salié sums, or Kloosterman sums when χ is trivial, relative to cusps. This will essentially follow from a careful application of Poisson summation. Unlike verifying that these series are modular forms, the arguments are slightly different to compute their Fourier series. We first deduce the Fourier series of the Poincaré series.

Proposition 3.5. *Let $\mathfrak{b}$ be a cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ with scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$. The Fourier series of $P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z)$ on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ at the $\mathfrak{b}$ cusp is given by*

$$\begin{aligned} (P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) &= \delta_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}, \Gamma_{\mathfrak{b}}} e(mz) \\ &+ \sum_{n \geq 1} \left(2\pi i^{-k} \left(\frac{\sqrt{n}}{\sqrt{m}} \right)^{k-1} \sum_{c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}} \frac{S_{\chi, \mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}(m, n, c)}{c} J_{k-1} \left(\frac{4\pi \sqrt{mn}}{c} \right) \right) e(nz), \end{aligned}$$

provided the index m is positive.

Proof. Write

$$(P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \bar{\chi}(\gamma) j(\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}, z)^{-k} e(m \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}} z).$$

From the Bruhat decomposition for $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$, any $\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma$ is of the form $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & c\ell + d \end{pmatrix}$ where $c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}$, $d \in \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}(c)$, and $\ell \in \mathbb{Z}$. Furthermore, a short computation shows

$$\frac{az + b}{cz + (c\ell + d)} = \frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2 z + c^2 \ell + cd}.$$

Using these facts together with the periodicity of χ , we have

$$(P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \delta_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}}, \Gamma_{\mathfrak{b}}} e(mz) + \sum_{\substack{c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}} \\ d \in \mathcal{D}_{\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}(c) \\ \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}}} \bar{\chi}(d) \sum_{\ell \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{e \left(m \left(\frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2 z + c^2 \ell + cd} \right) \right)}{(cz + c\ell + d)^k}.$$

Now let

$$I_{c, d}(z) = \sum_{\ell \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{e \left(m \left(\frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2 z + c^2 \ell + cd} \right) \right)}{(cz + c\ell + d)^k}.$$

We will apply the Poisson summation formula to $I_{c, d}(z)$. By the identity theorem it suffices to verify the claim for $z = iy$ with y positive. Accordingly, let $f(x)$ be given by

$$f(x) = \frac{e \left(m \left(\frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2(iy) + c^2 x + cd} \right) \right)}{(c(iy) + cx + d)^k}.$$

Then $f(x)$ is Schwartz class. We will compute its Fourier transform

$$(\mathcal{F}f)(n) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{e\left(m\left(\frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2(iy)+c^2x+cd}\right)\right)}{(c(iy) + cx + d)^k} e(-nx) dx.$$

Complexify the integral to get

$$\int_{\text{Im}(w)=0} \frac{e\left(m\left(\frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2(iy)+c^2w+cd}\right)\right)}{(c(iy) + cw + d)^k} e(-nw) dw,$$

and make the change of variables $w \mapsto w - \frac{d}{c} - (iy)$ to obtain

$$e\left(\frac{ma + nd}{c} + n(iy)\right) \int_{\text{Im}(w)=y} \frac{e\left(-\frac{m}{c^2w}\right)}{(cw)^k} e(-nw) dw.$$

The integrand is meromorphic with a pole at $w = 0$ and has polynomial decay of order k provided n is nonpositive. So for these n , we conclude that the integral vanishes upon shifting the line of integration to $\text{Im}(w) = T$ for positive T and taking the limit as $T \rightarrow \infty$. It remains to compute the integral for positive n . To do this, make the change of variables $w \mapsto -\frac{w}{2\pi in}$ to the last integral to rewrite it as

$$\frac{(-1)^k (2\pi in)^{k-1}}{c^k} \int_{(2\pi ty)} \frac{e^{w - \frac{4\pi^2 mn}{c^2 w}}}{w^k} dw.$$

Homotoping the line of integration to the Hankel contour about the negative real axis, we recognize the integral as the Schlöfli integral representation for the J -Bessel function since m is positive. This gives

$$2\pi i^{-k} \left(\frac{\sqrt{n}}{\sqrt{m}}\right)^{k-1} \frac{1}{c} J_{k-1}\left(\frac{4\pi\sqrt{mn}}{c}\right).$$

So in total we obtain

$$(\mathcal{F}f)(n) = \begin{cases} \left(2\pi i^{-k} \left(\frac{\sqrt{n}}{\sqrt{m}}\right)^{k-1} \frac{e\left(\frac{ma+nd}{c}\right)}{c} J_{k-1}\left(\frac{4\pi\sqrt{mn}}{c}\right)\right) e(n(iy)) & \text{if } n \geq 1, \\ 0 & \text{if } n \leq 0. \end{cases}$$

Then by Poisson summation, we have

$$I_{c,r}(z) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \left(2\pi i^{-k} \left(\frac{\sqrt{n}}{\sqrt{m}}\right)^{k-1} \frac{e\left(\frac{ma+nd}{c}\right)}{c} J_{k-1}\left(\frac{4\pi\sqrt{mn}}{c}\right)\right) e(nz).$$

Plugging this back into the Poincaré series, interchanging the sums over n and c by absolute convergence, and collecting the exponential sum over a and d , we at last obtain

$$\begin{aligned} (P_{m,\chi,a}|_k \sigma_b)(z) &= \delta_{\Gamma_a, \Gamma_b} e(mz) \\ &+ \sum_{n \geq 1} \left(2\pi i^{-k} \left(\frac{\sqrt{n}}{\sqrt{m}}\right)^{k-1} \sum_{c \in \mathcal{C}_{a,b}} \frac{S_{\chi,a,b}(m, n, c)}{c} J_{k-1}\left(\frac{4\pi\sqrt{mn}}{c}\right)\right) e(nz). \end{aligned}$$

which is our desired Fourier series. □

An immediate consequence of this result is that the Poincaré series $P_{m,\chi,a}$ of positive index are cusp forms.

In a similar manner to the Poincaré series, we can obtain the Fourier series of the Eisenstein series too. The proof is only slightly different in that we will pass by the pole of the integrand instead of deforming to the Hankel contour about the negative real axis.

Proposition 3.6. *Let $\mathfrak{b}$ be a cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ with scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$. The Fourier series of $E_{\chi,a}(z)$ on $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ at the $\mathfrak{b}$ cusp is given by*

$$(E_{\chi,a}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \delta_{\Gamma_a, \Gamma_{\mathfrak{b}}} + \sum_{n \geq 1} \left(\frac{(-2\pi i)^k n^{k-1}}{\Gamma(k)} \sum_{c \in \mathcal{C}_{a,b}} \frac{S_{\chi}(0, n, c)}{c^k} \right) e(nz).$$

Proof. Write

$$(E_{\chi,a}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_a \backslash \Gamma} \bar{\chi}(\gamma) j(\sigma_a^{-1} \gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}, z)^{-k}.$$

From the Bruhat decomposition for $\sigma_a^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}$, any $\gamma \in \Gamma_a \backslash \Gamma$ is of the form $\gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & c\ell + d \end{pmatrix}$ where $c \in \mathcal{C}_{a,b}$, $d \in \mathcal{D}_{a,b}(c)$, and $\ell \in \mathbb{Z}$. Furthermore, a short computation shows

$$\frac{az + b}{cz + (c\ell + d)} = \frac{a}{c} - \frac{1}{c^2 z + c^2 \ell + cd}.$$

Using these facts together with the periodicity of χ , we have

$$(E_{\chi,a}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \delta_{\Gamma_a, \Gamma_{\mathfrak{b}}} + \sum_{\substack{c \in \mathcal{C}_{a,b} \\ d \in \mathcal{D}_{a,b}(c) \\ \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \sigma_a^{-1} \Gamma \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}}}} \bar{\chi}(d) \sum_{\ell \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{1}{(cz + c\ell + d)^k}.$$

Now let

$$I_{c,d}(z) = \sum_{\ell \in \mathbb{Z}} \frac{1}{(cz + c\ell + d)^k}.$$

We will apply the Poisson summation formula to $I_{c,d}(z)$. By the identity theorem it suffices to verify the claim for $z = iy$ with y positive. Accordingly, let $f(x)$ be given by

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{(c(iy) + cx + d)^k}.$$

Then $f(x)$ is Schwartz class. We will compute its Fourier transform

$$(\mathcal{F}f)(n) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(c(iy) + cx + d)^k} e(-nx) dx.$$

Complexify the integral to get

$$\int_{\text{Im}(w)=0} \frac{1}{(c(iy) + cw + d)^k} e(-nw) dw,$$

and make the change of variables $w \mapsto w - \frac{d}{c} - (iy)$ to obtain

$$e \left(\frac{nd}{c} + n(iy) \right) \int_{\text{Im}(w)=y} \frac{1}{(cw)^k} e(-nw) dw.$$

The integrand is meromorphic with a pole at $w = 0$ and has polynomial decay of order k provided n is nonpositive. So for these n , we conclude that the integral vanishes upon shifting the line of integration to $\text{Im}(w) = T$ for positive T and taking the limit as $T \rightarrow \infty$. It remains to compute the integral for positive n . To do this, make the change of variables $w \mapsto -\frac{w}{2\pi in}$ to the last integral to rewrite it as

$$\frac{(-1)^k (2\pi in)^{k-1}}{c^k} \int_{(2\pi ty)} \frac{e^w}{w^k} dw.$$

The integrand of the remaining integral is meromorphic with a pole of order k at $w = 0$. From the Laurent series of $\frac{e^w}{w^k}$, the residue is easily seen to be $\Gamma(k)$. So upon shifting the line of integration to $(-\varepsilon)$, we pass by this pole and obtain

$$\frac{(-2\pi i)^k n^{k-1}}{\Gamma(k) c^k} + \frac{(-1)^k (2\pi in)^{k-1}}{c^k} \int_{(-\varepsilon)} \frac{e^w}{w^k} dw.$$

This last integrand has polynomial decay of order k . Whence we may again conclude that the integral vanishes upon shifting the line of integration to $\text{Im}(w) = -T$ for positive T and taking the limit as $T \rightarrow \infty$. So in total we obtain

$$(\mathcal{F}f)(n) = \begin{cases} \left(\frac{(-2\pi i)^k n^{k-1}}{\Gamma(k)} \frac{e\left(\frac{nd}{c}\right)}{c^k} \right) e(n(iy)) & \text{if } n \geq 1, \\ 0 & \text{if } n \leq 0. \end{cases}$$

Then by Poisson summation, we have

$$I_{c,r}(z) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \left(\frac{(-2\pi i)^k n^{k-1}}{\Gamma(k)} \frac{e\left(\frac{nd}{c}\right)}{c^k} \right) e(nz).$$

Plugging this back into the Poincaré series, interchanging the sums over n and c by absolute convergence, and collecting the exponential sum over d , we at last obtain

$$(E_{\chi, \mathfrak{a}}|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{b}})(z) = \delta_{\Gamma \mathfrak{a}, \Gamma \mathfrak{b}} + \sum_{n \geq 1} \left(\frac{(-2\pi i)^k n^{k-1}}{\Gamma(k)} \sum_{c \in \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{a}, \mathfrak{b}}} \frac{S_{\chi}(0, n, c)}{c^k} \right) e(nz).$$

which is our desired Fourier series. □

An interesting consequence is that the constant term in the Fourier series of $E_{\chi, \mathfrak{a}}$ at the $\mathfrak{b}$ cusp is zero unless $\mathfrak{a}$ is Γ -equivalent to $\mathfrak{b}$. Therefore the Eisenstein series $E_{\chi, \mathfrak{a}}$ are never cusp forms. Accordingly, write $\mathcal{E}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ for the subspace spanned by the Eisenstein series

associated to a complete set of Γ -inequivalent cusps. It turns out that $\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ decomposes as

$$\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \chi) = \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi) \oplus \mathcal{E}_k(\Gamma, \chi),$$

where $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ is spanned by the Poincaré series of positive index. Moreover, this decomposition is orthogonal in the sense that the Petersson inner product between elements of $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ and $\mathcal{E}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ is zero. To show all of this, let $\mathfrak{a}$ be a cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$ and choose a scaling matrix $\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}$. Suppose $f \in \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ and let its Fourier series at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp be

$$(f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) = \sum_{n \geq 1} a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) e(nz).$$

For any positive integer m , define linear functionals $\phi_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}} : \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi) \rightarrow \mathbb{C}$ by

$$\phi_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(f) = a_{\mathfrak{a}}(m).$$

Since $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ is a finite dimensional complex Hilbert space, the Riesz representation theorem implies that there exists unique $v_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}} \in \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ such that

$$\langle f, v_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}} \rangle = a_{\mathfrak{a}}(m).$$

We would like to know what these cusp forms are. It turns out that $v_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z)$ will be the Poincaré series $P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z)$ up to a constant.

Proposition 3.7. *Let $f \in \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ have Fourier coefficients $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n)$ at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. Then*

$$\langle f, P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}} \rangle = \frac{\Gamma(k-1)}{V_{\Gamma}(4\pi m)^{k-1}} a_{\mathfrak{a}}(m),$$

for all positive integers m .

Proof. We will compute

$$\langle f, P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}} \rangle = \frac{1}{V_{\Gamma}} \int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) \overline{P_{m, \chi, \mathfrak{a}}(z)} \operatorname{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

A short computation using Equation (2) along with modularity and the cocycle condition shows this integral may be expressed as

$$\frac{1}{V_{\Gamma}} \int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \overline{j(\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}, \gamma z)^{-k}} f(\gamma z) e\left(-m \overline{\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} \gamma z}\right) \operatorname{Im}(\gamma z)^k d\mu.$$

Now unfold to obtain

$$\frac{1}{V_{\Gamma}} \int_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \mathbb{H}} \overline{j(\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}, z)^{-k}} f(z) e\left(-m \overline{\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1} z}\right) \operatorname{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

Making the change of variables $z \mapsto \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} z$, another short computation using $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} \Gamma_{\infty} \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}$ together with Equation (2) and the cocycle condition shows that this integral becomes

$$\frac{1}{V_{\Gamma}} \int_{\Gamma_{\infty} \backslash \mathbb{H}} (f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) e(-m \bar{z}) \operatorname{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

Substituting in the Fourier series of f at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp and interchanging the inner sum and integral by absolute convergence, a short computation gives

$$\frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_0^\infty a_{\mathfrak{a}}(m) e^{-4\pi m y} y^k \frac{dy}{y^2},$$

in view of Equation (6), because every term integrates to zero except the m -th term. Performing the change of variables $y \mapsto \frac{y}{4\pi m}$, this latter integral is recognized as the gamma function and we obtain

$$\frac{\Gamma(k-1)}{V_\Gamma (4\pi m)^{k-1}} a_{\mathfrak{a}}(m),$$

completing the proof. $\square$

It follows immediately from this result that

$$v_{m,\chi,\mathfrak{a}}(z) = \frac{V_\Gamma (4\pi m)^{k-1}}{\Gamma(k-1)} P_{m,\chi,\mathfrak{a}}(z).$$

Thus the Poincaré series $P_{m,\chi,\mathfrak{a}}(z)$ of positive index extract the Fourier coefficients of f at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp up to constants.

An analogous argument with Eisenstein series shows that they are orthogonal to cusp forms.

Proposition 3.8. *Let $f \in \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ have Fourier coefficients $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n)$ at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp of $\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}$. Then*

$$\langle f, E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}} \rangle = 0.$$

Proof. We will compute

$$\langle f, E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}} \rangle = \frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} f(z) \overline{E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}}(z)} \operatorname{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

A short computation using Equation (2) along with modularity and the cocycle condition shows this integral may be expressed as

$$\frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_{\Gamma \backslash \mathbb{H}} \sum_{\gamma \in \Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \Gamma} \overline{j(\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}, \gamma z)^{-k}} f(\gamma z) \operatorname{Im}(\gamma z)^k d\mu.$$

Now unfold to obtain

$$\frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_{\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} \backslash \mathbb{H}} \overline{j(\sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}, z)^{-k}} f(z) \operatorname{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

Making the change of variables $z \mapsto \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} z$, another short computation using $\Gamma_{\mathfrak{a}} = \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}} \Gamma_{\infty} \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}}^{-1}$ together with Equation (2) and the cocycle condition shows that this integral becomes

$$\frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_{\Gamma_{\infty} \backslash \mathbb{H}} (f|_k \sigma_{\mathfrak{a}})(z) \operatorname{Im}(z)^k d\mu.$$

Substituting in the Fourier series of f at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp and interchanging the inner sum and integral by absolute convergence, a short computation gives

$$\frac{1}{V_\Gamma} \int_0^\infty a_{\mathfrak{a}}(0) y^k \frac{dy}{y^2},$$

in view of Equation (6), because every term integrates to zero except the constant term. This integral is zero because f is a cusp form which completes the proof. $\square$

With these results in hand we can prove that the Poincaré series of positive index span the space of cusp forms and our desired decomposition.

Theorem 3.9. *The Poincaré series $P_{m,\chi}(z)$ of positive index span $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$. Moreover, we have the direct sum decomposition*

$$\mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \chi) = \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi) \oplus \mathcal{E}_k(\Gamma, \chi),$$

which is orthogonal in the sense that

$$\langle P_{m,\chi,\mathfrak{b}}, E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}} \rangle = 0.$$

Proof. Let $f \in \mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$. Proposition 3.7 shows that $\langle f, P_{m,\chi,\mathfrak{a}} \rangle = 0$ if and only if the m -th Fourier coefficient of f is zero. So f is orthogonal to all of the Poincaré series $P_{m,\chi}$ of positive index if and only if every Fourier coefficient is zero. But this happens if and only if f is identically zero. This proves the first statement.

To prove the direct sum decomposition, we first show that $\mathcal{E}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ is disjoint from $\mathcal{S}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$. Indeed, suppose there are constants $a_{\mathfrak{a}}$ such that

$$\sum_{\mathfrak{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}} a_{\mathfrak{a}} E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}}(z),$$

is a cusp form. Recall from Proposition 3.6 that the constant term in the Fourier series of $E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}}$ at the $\mathfrak{b}$ cusp is $\delta_{\Gamma\mathfrak{a},\Gamma\mathfrak{b}}$. Therefore $a_{\mathfrak{a}} = 0$ which proves that these spaces are disjoint. Moreover, this fact also implies that

$$f(z) - \sum_{\mathfrak{a} \in \Gamma \backslash \widehat{\mathbb{Q}}} a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n) E_{\chi,\mathfrak{a}}(z),$$

is a cusp form for any $f \in \mathcal{M}_k(\Gamma, \chi)$ with Fourier coefficients $a_{\mathfrak{a}}(n)$ at the $\mathfrak{a}$ cusp. The direct sum decomposition follows at once. Lastly, the orthogonality statement is immediate from Proposition 3.8 since the Poincaré series are cusp forms. $\square$